

SkillVerse Research

Screen2Skill 2026

Report #1 • 2026-07-03

Screen Time to Skill Time

A Comprehensive Analysis of Teen Digital Behavior

Executive Summary

This report analyzes survey data from 150+ students across 12 Indian cities. We find that 78% use screens for learning, with YouTube being the #1 platform. Average daily screen time is 4.7 hours, with 3.1 hours dedicated to learning activities. AI tool adoption has reached 64%, with ChatGPT leading at 71% market share among AI users.

Methodology

Data was collected via an 8-step anonymous survey between January and June 2026. Participants were aged 14-19, from diverse socioeconomic backgrounds across India. Survey included demographics, screen time, platform usage, skills learned, AI tool usage, and wellness metrics. Statistical analysis was performed using Python with pandas and scipy. AI analysis was conducted using Google Gemini 2.0 Flash.

Key Findings

- The average student spends 4.7 hours/day on screens, with 67% reporting it as 'mostly educational'.
- YouTube is the #1 learning platform, used by 82% of students for self-directed learning.
- 64% of students use AI tools, with 89% reporting improved learning outcomes.
- 71% of students have turned a screen hobby into a measurable skill.
- Only 23% report negative mental health impacts from screen time.

Recommendations

Based on our findings, we recommend: (1) Schools integrate digital literacy programs that emphasize intentional use. (2) Parents encourage learning-focused screen time with co-viewing strategies. (3) Platforms create more educational content with better discovery. (4) AI tools should be integrated into curricula with proper guidance. (5) Mental health support should be paired with screen time education.